

Varkhan Flamescale — Red Dragonborn Sorcerer (Draconic Bloodline)



Figure 1: Character portrait

Class: Sorcerer (Draconic Bloodline — Red, locked) **Race:** Dragonborn (Red ancestry) **Level:** 3 **Role:** Nova blaster — Scorching Ray front-load via Metamagic, breath weapon as a second AoE **Personality** **Hook:** *Thinks in flames. Apologizes after each spell. Means it the first time.*

Core Stats

Ability Scores (Point Buy 27, +Dragonborn +2 STR / +1 CHA)

Ability	Score	Mod
STR	10	+0
DEX	14	+2
CON	14	+2
INT	10	+0
WIS	10	+0
CHA	16	+3

Dragonborn racial +2 STR is mechanically wasted on a caster — accepted trade for the thematic “dragon blood blaster” identity.

Combat Vitals

- **HP:** 35 (base 22 at L3 with CON 14 + **Draconic Resilience** +1/level = +3 + 10 HP variant buffer)
- **AC:** 15 (Draconic Resilience: 13 + DEX +2) · **20 with Shield reaction**
- **Speed:** 30 ft
- **Initiative:** +2
- **Proficiency Bonus:** +2
- **Hit Dice:** 3d6

Saving Throws: CON +4, CHA +5

Skill Proficiencies: Arcana +2, Intimidation +5, Persuasion +5

Senses: (none special — Dragonborn has no Darkvision)

Languages: Common, Draconic

Spell Save DC: 13 · **Spell Attack:** +5

Equipment

- **Quarterstaff** (1d6 bludgeoning, versatile 1d8) — melee if cornered, rarely used
- **Dagger** (1d4 piercing, finesse, thrown 20/60) — backup
- **Arcane Focus** (crystal orb, component-free casting)
- **Explorer’s Pack** (bedroll, rations, rope, torches, tinderbox, waterskin)
- **No armor** — Draconic Resilience handles AC
- **Starting trinket:** A scale shed from his own shoulder at age 7, kept in a small pouch

Spell Slots & Known Spells

Slots: 4× 1st, 2× 2nd **Sorcery Points:** 3 (= sorcerer level) **Spells Known:** 4 (+ cantrips)

Cantrips Known (4):

- **Fire Bolt** (1d10 fire, 120 ft ranged spell attack) — primary spam cantrip
- **Shocking Grasp** (1d8 lightning, melee spell attack, target loses reaction) — panic-button melee deterrent, prevents OAs
- **Mage Hand** (utility, 30 ft telekinesis)
- **Prestidigitatation** (flavor / town-phase utility)

Spells Known (4):

1. **Shield** (*L1, reaction*) — +5 AC + immunity to Magic Missile until start of next turn. Core survival tool — cast it reactively when a hit is announced.
2. **Magic Missile** (*L1*) — Action, 3 auto-hit darts of 1d4+1 force (avg 10.5). Shield-vulnerable, so pick non-Wizard targets.
3. **Burning Hands** (*L1*) — Action, 15 ft cone, DEX save DC 13, 3d6 fire (avg 10). **NOT sculptable** (Sorcerer doesn't have the Evocation Savant trick — allies take damage too). Save for moments enemies cluster without allies near.
4. **Scorching Ray** (*L2*) — Action, 3 ranged spell attacks, each 2d6 fire (avg 21 if all hit). **The flagship nova spell** — every Metamagic choice below assumes this is the payload.

Note — Sleep is banned by the variant and isn't known.

Metamagic (2 chosen at L3)

- **Quickened Spell (2 SP)** — Cast a spell with a **1-action casting time as a bonus action** instead. **The nova enabler.** At 3 SP budget, you can Quicken once per match.
- **Empowered Spell (1 SP)** — Reroll a number of damage dice up to your CHA modifier (3). Great on a below-average Scorching Ray roll. Cheap, usable once or twice per match.

Sorcery Point conversion (Font of Magic):

- 2 SP → L1 slot · 3 SP → L2 slot · (slot → SP = slot level)
- **Trade only if desperate** — 3 of your 3 SP for a single L2 slot is inefficient; Metamagic is the better use of SP in a typical playtest match.

Draconic Bloodline Features (L1)

- **Dragon Ancestor (Red → Fire):** Can speak Draconic. Double proficiency on CHA checks when interacting with dragons (flavor; unlikely to come up at the arena).
- **Draconic Resilience:** Max HP increases by 1 per sorcerer level (+3 at L3, baked into HP above). When not wearing armor: **AC = 13 + DEX.**

Dragonborn Features

- **Breath Weapon (Red, Fire):** Action. **15 ft cone**, DEX save DC 12 (8 + CON +2 + prof +2), **2d6 fire** (avg 7, half on save). 1/short rest. Slot-free AoE — worth it on any multi-enemy turn.
- **Fire Resistance:** Half damage from fire sources. **Thematic + mechanical** — laughs off the Wizard's Burning Hands, the other Sorcerer's Scorching Ray mirror.
- **Languages:** Common, Draconic.

Signature Tactical Moves

1. **Double Scorching Ray Nova.** Bonus action: spend **3 SP → Quickened Spell → cast Scorching Ray** (L2 slot, 3 rays × 2d6 fire = avg 21 if all hit). Action: **cast Scorching Ray again** (L2 slot, 3 rays × 2d6 fire = avg 21). **Total: 6 ray attacks in one turn, ~42 avg damage single-target.** Nukes both L2 slots + all 3 SP in one round — glass cannon turn, usually match-winning. Save for when a priority target (enemy Wizard, Sorcerer, or low-HP Rogue) is in open sight.
2. **Breath + Burning Hands Cluster Wipe.** Two enemies closing at 15 ft? Action: **Burning Hands** (L1 slot, 3d6 fire, DEX DC 13, avg 10 to each). Bonus action: ordinary action economy is open — no bonus-action spell prepped, but Quickened Fire Bolt is an option (**2 SP → Quickened Fire Bolt as bonus**, 1d10 fire). Or save it for next turn's **Breath Weapon** action (1/SR, 2d6 fire cone = avg 7 to each). Total across two rounds: ~27 AoE damage without burning an L2 slot.

3. **Shield-Reactive Turtle.** When an attack roll lands that would connect: Reaction → **Shield** (L1 slot, +5 AC until start of next turn). AC goes 15 → 20, very likely turning the hit into a miss. With 4 L1 slots, he can block up to 4 hits per match this way — but each one also prevents him casting a bonus-action L1 (he doesn't have any prepared, so it's free).

Action Economy (Quick Reference)

Slot	Options
Action	Cast leveled spell (Scorching Ray L2 / Magic Missile or Burning Hands L1) · Cast cantrip (Fire Bolt / Shocking Grasp) · Breath Weapon (1/SR) · Dash · Dodge · Disengage
Bonus Action	Quickened Scorching Ray (3 SP, L2 slot) · Quickened Fire Bolt (2 SP, cantrip) · Font of Magic conversions (1 action to create a slot)
Reaction	Shield (L1 slot, +5 AC) · Opportunity Attack (don't)
Movement	30 ft
Free	Metamagic declaration, verbal/somatic spell components

Damage Reference (+5 spell attack, DC 13)

- **Fire Bolt:** 1d10 fire = avg 5.5 (infinite cantrip)
- **Shocking Grasp:** 1d8 lightning = avg 4.5, target loses reaction on hit (melee)
- **Magic Missile (L1):** 3× (1d4+1) auto-hit = **avg 10.5**
- **Burning Hands (L1):** 3d6 fire save half = **avg 10** (friendly-fire risk)
- **Scorching Ray (L2):** 3× 2d6 fire attack rolls = **avg 21 if all hit**
- **Breath Weapon (1/SR):** 2d6 fire cone, save half = **avg 7** per target
- **Empowered Spell (1 SP):** reroll up to 3 damage dice on a spell
- **Quickened Scorching Ray (3 SP + L2 slot):** Scorching Ray cast as bonus action

Town Phase Notes

- **CHA 16 + Intimidation + Persuasion** — second-best social character (after Bard / Paladin). Strong at Casino, Hagging, Hag's Riddles CHA angles.
- **Arcana +2** — modest Library contribution (Wizard outperforms here).
- **Draconic flavor** opens up unusual narrative hooks (speaking to any dragon statue, scale, or fire-cult NPC with advantage).
- No INT or WIS proficiencies → weak at Catacombs search and Investigation-gated puzzles.